

PAC ML Competition: Results & Reflections

FINAL RESULT: Ranked #7 on Private Leaderboard (Top 2%) → Score 247.3331

What I Did Right

- Strong feature engineering
- Compared multiple ML models early
- Identified Linear Regression family as top performer and focused improvements there
- Built clean, reproducible modeling pipelines



Where I Went Wrong

- Under-explored nonlinear interactions
- PCA added complexity without improving performance
- Limited parameter tuning
- Not enough exploration of feature importance and residual patterns early



If I Redid This

- Automate feature engineering to capture richer interactions
- Skip PCA unless necessary to preserve interpretability
- Ensemble multiple models for stronger RMSE
- Treat outliers for more stable predictions

